

Reported Commands & Requests

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Report commands and requests with reporting verb + object + to-infinitive:

- 1 Commands use 'tell' — 'Sit down.' → He told me to sit down.
- 2 Requests use 'ask' — 'Please help.' → She asked me to help.
- 3 Negatives put 'not' before 'to' — 'Don't go.' → He told me not to go.

No tenses to backshift here — just the to-infinitive. Always include the person (told me, asked her), unlike 'say'.

At a glance

Direct speech	Reported speech
"Sit down."	He told me to sit down.
"Please wait."	She asked me to wait.
"Don't touch that."	He told me not to touch that.
"Remember to call."	She reminded me to call.
"Don't be late."	He warned me not to be late.

Learning objectives

- Can report commands and requests with tell/ask + object + to-infinitive (CEFR B1).
- Can form negatives with 'not to'.
- Can select the reporting verb (tell, ask, advise, warn, remind).



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Reported Commands & Requests · CEFR B1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. "Sit down." → The teacher told us ____ down.

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|------------|-------------|
| A. to sit | B. sit |
| C. sitting | D. that sit |

2. "Please help me." → She asked me ____ her.

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|------------|--------------|
| A. to help | B. help |
| C. helping | D. that help |

3. "Don't touch the stove." → He told me ____ the stove.

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. not to touch | B. to not touch |
| C. don't touch | D. not touch |

4. "Remember to lock the door." → She reminded me ____ the door.

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| A. to lock | B. lock |
| C. locking | D. that lock |

5. Correct this: 'He told to wait.'

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|------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| A. He told me to wait. | B. He told to wait me. |
| C. He told wait. | D. The sentence is already correct. |

6. "Could you close the door, please?" → She asked him ____ the door.

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|-------------|-----------|
| A. to close | B. close |
| C. closing | D. closed |

7. "Don't be late." → He warned us ____ late.

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|--------------|--------------|
| A. not to be | B. to not be |
| C. don't be | D. not being |

8. "Take these pills twice a day." → The doctor advised her ____ the pills twice a day.

- | | |
|------------|--------------|
| A. to take | B. take |
| C. taking | D. that take |

9. Which sentence reports a command correctly?

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|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| A. She said me to leave. | B. She told me to leave. |
| C. She told me leave. | D. She told to me leave. |

10. "Please don't tell anyone." → He asked me ____ anyone.

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|----------------|----------------|
| A. not to tell | B. to not tell |
| C. don't tell | D. not telling |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. to sit** — Commands use 'tell + object + to-infinitive': 'told us to sit down'.
2. **A. to help** — Requests use 'ask + object + to-infinitive': 'asked me to help her'.
3. **A. not to touch** — Negatives put 'not' before 'to': 'told me not to touch'.
4. **A. to lock** — 'Remind + object + to-infinitive': 'reminded me to lock the door'.
5. **A. He told me to wait.** — 'Tell' needs an object: 'He told me to wait'.
6. **A. to close** — Polite request: 'asked him to close the door'.
7. **A. not to be** — 'Warn + object + not to': 'warned us not to be late'.
8. **A. to take** — 'Advise + object + to-infinitive': 'advised her to take the pills'.
9. **B. She told me to leave.** — 'Tell + object + to-infinitive': 'She told me to leave'.
10. **A. not to tell** — Negative request: 'asked me not to tell anyone'.